

SOC Lab Investigation #4 – Suspicious Account Creation & Privilege Escalation

Alert:

New User Account / Administrators Group Changed

Severity: Level 12

Investigation:

Wazuh detected the creation of a new Windows account named "temp-admin-test." I reviewed the events and confirmed with Event ID 4720 that the account was created by the user "Whyde." I also found that the account was added to the local Administrators group. Event ID 4732 confirmed the change, and Wazuh generated a Level 12 alert. I checked for successful logins to temp-admin-test but did not find any.

Conclusion:

The investigation confirmed that a new account was created and given administrator privileges. No successful logins were found. The activity was intentionally performed as part of the SOC lab, and the test account was removed after the investigation.

Evidence:

Event ID: 4720 – User Account Created

Event ID: 4732 – Member Added to Local Group

Wazuh Rule ID: 60154

Wazuh Level: 12

Account: temp-admin-test

Group: Administrators

Windows Event ID 4720 showing the creation of the temp-admin-test account.

Document Details

data.win.eventdata.subjectLo

0x4436c

gonid

data.win.eventdata.subjectUs

Whyde

erName

data.win.eventdata.subjectUs

S-1-5-21-4118335691-692745449-3814570756-1004

ersid

data.win.eventdata.targetDom

Gonzilla

ainName

data.win.eventdata.targetSid

S-1-5-21-4118335691-692745449-3814570756-1010

data.win.eventdata.targetUse

temp-admin-test

rName

data.win.eventdata.userAccou

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ntControl

data.win.eventdata.userParam

%%1793

eters

data.win.eventdata.userWorks

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tations

data.win.system.channel

Security

data.win.system.computer

Gonzilla

data.win.system.eventID

4720

data.win.system.eventRecordID

3449100

data.win.system.keywords

0x0020000000000000

data.win.system.level

0

data.win.system.message

Attributes:

SAM Account Name:

temp-admin-test

Display Name:

<value not set>

User Principal Name:

-

Home Directory:

<value not set>

Wazuh Level 12 alert showing that the local Administrators group was changed.

1 hit				
Aug 20, 2026 @ 17:12:30.006 - Aug 20, 2026 @ 17:27:30.006				
Export Formatted	Reset view	768 available fields	Columns	Density
timestamp	agent_name	rule_description	rule_level	rule_id
Aug 20, 2026 @ 17:26:30.4...	Windows-pc	Administrators Group Changed	12	60154

Windows Event ID 4732 confirming that the new account was added to the local Administrators group.

Document Details		View surrounding documents	View single document	X
data.win.eventdata.memberSid	S-1-5-21-4110335691-692745449-3814570756-1010			
data.win.eventdata.subjectDomainName	GONZILLA			
data.win.eventdata.subjectLogonId	0x4436c			
data.win.eventdata.subjectUserName	Whyde			
data.win.eventdata.subjectUserSid	S-1-5-21-4110335691-692745449-3814570756-1004	🔍	🔍	📄
data.win.eventdata.targetDomainName	Builtin			
data.win.eventdata.targetSid	S-1-5-32-544			
data.win.eventdata.targetUserName	Administrators			
data.win.system.channel	Security			
data.win.system.computer	Gonzilla			
data.win.system.eventID	4732			
data.win.system.eventRecordID	3449430			
data.win.system.keywords	0x8020000000000000			
data.win.system.level	0			
data.win.system.message	"A member was added to a security-enabled local group."			
	Subject:			
	Security ID:	S-1-5-21-4110335691-692745449-3814570756-1004		
	Account Name:	Whyde		
	Account Domain:	GONZILLA		
	Logon ID:	0x4436c		
data.win.system.opcode	0			
data.win.system.processID	1716			
data.win.system.providerGuid	{54849625-5478-4004-a5ba-9a3b0223c301}			